

Shuttling between brilliance and despair

GETTY IMAGES

Even though 2024 was a mixed bag for Indian shuttlers, promising achievements by youngsters and para-athletes offer hope for a **brighter future**.

Rajdeep Saha

rajdeep.saha@thehindu.co.in

Badminton's exclusion from the upcoming 2026 Commonwealth Games (CWG) in Glasgow, Scotland, was perhaps the biggest news from the sport last year. This move copped flak from some of India's prominent names in badminton, given the country's impressive tally of 31 medals in the racquet

sport at the CWG.

Apart from this revelation, the year witnessed retirements, heartbreaks, and athletes criticising their federations.

Before looking ahead, it is worthwhile to reflect on the major moments in badminton from the past year.

The dichotomy of the Paris Games

The Paris Olympics proved disappointing for Indian shuttlers, with the exception of Lakshya Sen (**right**), who had an impressive run in the tournament. The men's doubles pair of Satwiksairaj Rankireddy and Chirag Shetty entered as firm favourites to win a medal but crashed out at the quarterfinal stage.

Two-time medallist PV Sindhu arrived in Paris out of form, which became evident at the La



GETTY IMAGES